

Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters



Decorative Raglan Seams

Discover an unlimited number of decorative seam decreases for raglan sweaters. Choose plain or fancy, simple or detailed.

All of the following techniques are hand manipulated and can be worked on any machine with any yarn.

Take time to learn a new technique and personalize your next raglan sweater.

Contents

Simple Decreases	- 2 -
Simple Edge Decrease	- 2 -
Two Stitch Simple Edge Decrease	- 3 -
Three Stitch Simple Edge Decrease	- 3 -
Transferred Decreases	- 5 -
One Stitch Transferred Edge Decrease	- 5 -
Three Stitch Transferred Edge Decrease	- 6 -
Eyelet Decreases	- 8 -
Eyelet 1	- 8 -
Eyelet 2	- 9 -
Eyelet Challenge	- 10 -
Seaming	- 11 -
Mattress Stitch	- 11 -
Seam on the Machine	- 12 -
Seam with Crochet	- 12 -
i-Cord Insert	- 13 -
Sew-as-you-Go	- 14 -
Change the Decrease Rate	- 15 -
Simple Every 4 th Row Decrease	- 15 -
Simple Every 6 th Row Decrease	- 16 -
Fancy Decreases	- 17 -
Bias Decrease	- 17 -
1 over 2 Twist	- 19 -
1 Over 2 Twist Challenge	- 20 -
Arrowheads	- 21 -

Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

Simple Decreases

Simple Edge Decrease

1 Prong Transfer Tool

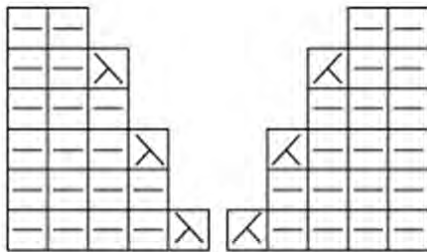


- Transfer the edge stitch to its neighbor every other row

This is a fast decrease method that has limitations.

Seaming can be difficult. There is no seaming stitch to neatly join the 2 edges. You can use a sewing machine or serger to seam.

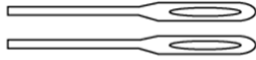
In this example, we grafted the stitches from the purl side, creating a raised, cable-like decorative seam on the knit side of the work.



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

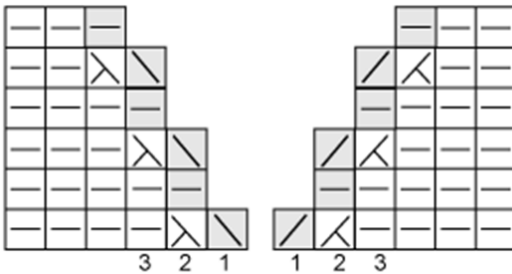
Two Stitch Simple Edge Decrease

2 Prong Transfer Tool



- Transfer 2 edge stitches over one needle. (2 stitches on the 3rd needle)
- Take the emptied needle to out of work position to complete the decrease.
- Repeat every other row

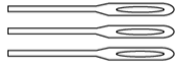
This creates an edge stitch column (grey stitches on the chart) that can be used for seaming.



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

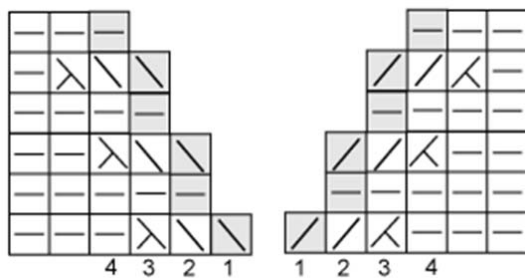
Three Stitch Simple Edge Decrease

3 Print Transfer Tool



- Transfer needles number 1-2-3 over one needle. (2 stitches on the 4th needle)
- Take the emptied needle to out of work position to complete the decrease
- Repeat every other row

This creates an edge stitch column (grey stitches on the chart) that can be used for seaming PLUS a decorative column of stitches on each side of the seam.



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

Transferred Decreases

One Stitch Transferred Edge Decrease

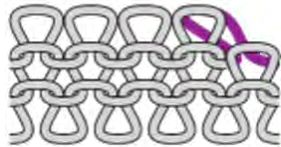
1 Prong Transfer Tool



Work the decrease in 2 steps to create a decorative seam.

- Transfer needle #2 to the outside edge needle (2 stitches on the needle)
- Transfer the 2 stitches to the emptied needle
- Put the emptied edge needle in out of work position to complete the decrease.

This creates an edge stitch column (grey stitches on the chart) that can be used for seaming



Mattress stitch $\frac{1}{2}$ of each edge stitch

Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

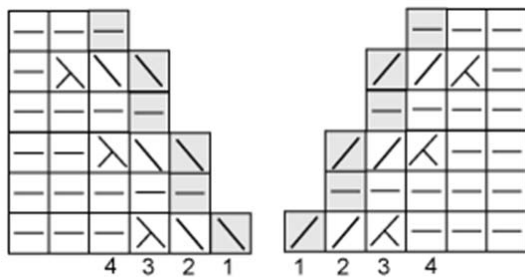
Three Stitch Transferred Edge Decrease

1 Prong, then 3 Prong Transfer Tool



- Transfer the 4th stitch toward the seam edge, (2 stitches on one needle and one emptied needle)
- Transfer the stitches from 3 needles to fill the emptied needle.
- Finish the decrease by putting the newly emptied needle in out of work position

This creates an edge stitch column (grey stitches on the chart) that can be used for seaming PLUS defined decorative column of stitches

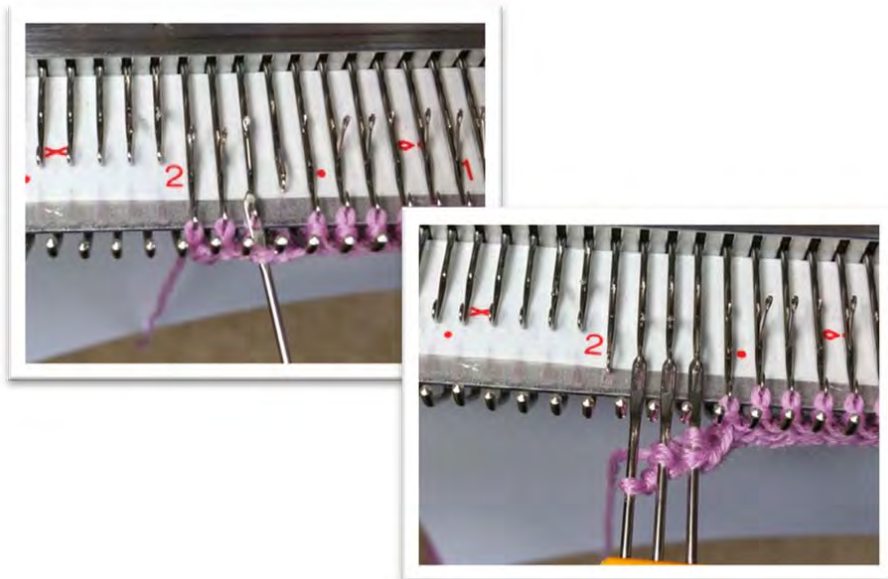


Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

Three Stitch Transferred Edge Decrease (continued)

2 Steps:

1. Transfer 1 stitch towards the seam, doubling up 2 stitches on one needle
2. Transfer the new group of stitches over 1 needle to fill the emptied needle
3. Take the decreased needle to out of work position



Decorative Raglan Seams

for Machine Knitters

Eyelet Decreases

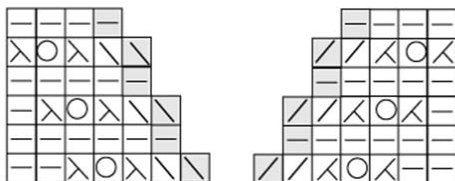
Eyelet 1

1 and 2 Prong Transfer Tool



- Transfer 2 edge stitches over one needle. (2 stitches on the 3rd needle – Simple Decrease)
- Take the emptied needle to out of work position to complete the decrease.
- Transfer the 3rd stitch to put 3 stitches on one needle and leave the emptied needle in working position to create an eyelet
- Knit 2 rows and repeat

This creates an edge stitch column (grey stitches on the chart) that can be used for seaming, a “cabled” column PLUS a small decorative eyelet



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

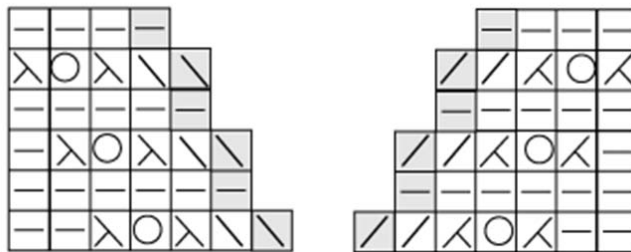
Eyelet 2

1 and 2 Prong Transfer Tool



- Work a 3 stitch transferred decrease (2 steps), putting the emptied needle in out of work position.
- Transfer the stitch next to the doubled stitches AWAY from the seam and leave the emptied needle in working position
- Knit 2 rows and repeat

This creates an edge stitch column (grey stitches on the chart) that can be used for seaming, a defined “full fashioned” column PLUS a larger decorative eyelet



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters



Eyelet Challenge

Make it your own!

- Vary the number of needles
- Combine Decrease techniques

Combining the techniques covered, how would you create this eyelet decrease seam? Notice the difference between the previous eyelet seam and the challenge seam.



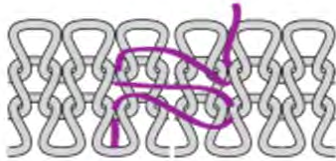
Hint: Transferred Decrease – Eyelet – Transferred Decrease

Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

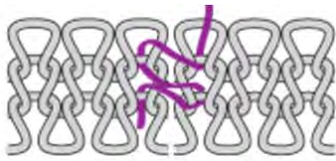
Seaming

Mattress Stitch

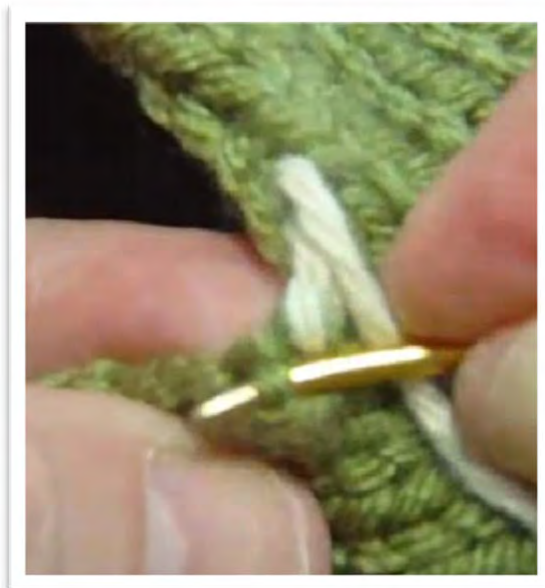
No matter what technique you use for your decreases, leaving a seaming stitch along the edge makes for easier seaming.



You can join by picking up 1 full stitch on each side.



Or you can create a less bulky seam by picking up $\frac{1}{2}$ stitch on each side.



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

Seam on the Machine

If you prefer to seam on the machine, leaving a seaming stitch also helps make this easier.

- Hang one side of the seam on the needles with the right (public) side facing you.
- Push the work behind the latches.
- Hang the other side of the work with the wrong (private) side facing you. (The right sides of the garment will be facing each other.) Leave these strands in the hooks of the needles
- Pull the strands in the hooks through the first piece.
- Bind off. Or knit 1 row and bind off.



Seam with Crochet

- With the right (public) sides facing, slip stitch, single or double crochet to join the seam
~or~
- With the wrong (private) sides together, slip stitch, single or double crochet to join the seam

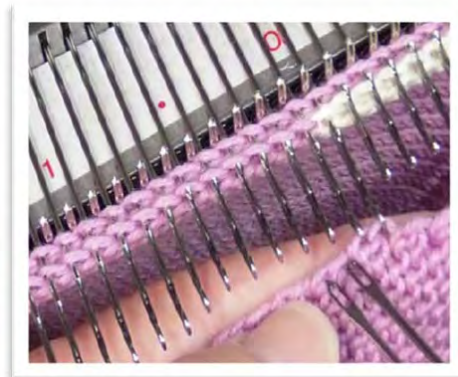
Crochet is fast, adds texture to the public (right) side of the sweater and gives a nice casual finish.

Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

i-Cord Insert

Join your seams on the machine, but dress them up with a bit of pre-knit i-Cord “sandwiched” in between. Knit the cord in your garment yarn or a contrasting color for interest.

- Hang one side of the seam on the needles with the right (public) side facing you.
- Hang a single strand of one column of the i-Cord on the same needles
- Push the work behind the latches
- With the wrong (private) side facing you, hang a single strand of the other side of the seam in the hooks of the needles
- Pull the strands in the hooks through the other pieces.
- Bind off.



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

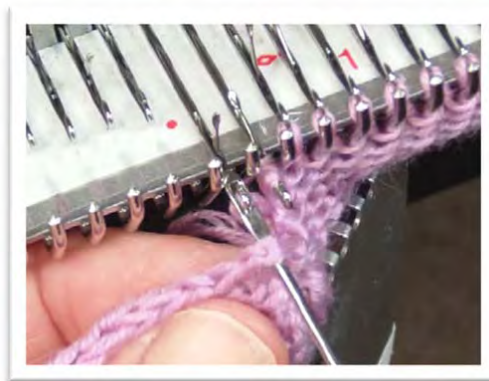
Sew-as-you-Go

Join your seams as you knit your pieces!

- Working any decrease method of your choice, knit the first piece.
- With the wrong (private) side facing, hang the decrease edge of the first piece on the first needle in work.
 - o Work your decrease, taking the emptied needle to out of work position
 - o Hang the edge of your first piece on the first needle in work (2 strands on the end needle)
 - o Knit 2 rows
 - o Repeat



With sew-as-you-go, you create a cabled column at the seam. The example was worked with a 2 stitch simple decrease, but you could use any decrease method you like.

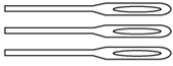


Decorative Raglan Seams

for Machine Knitters

Change the Decrease Rate

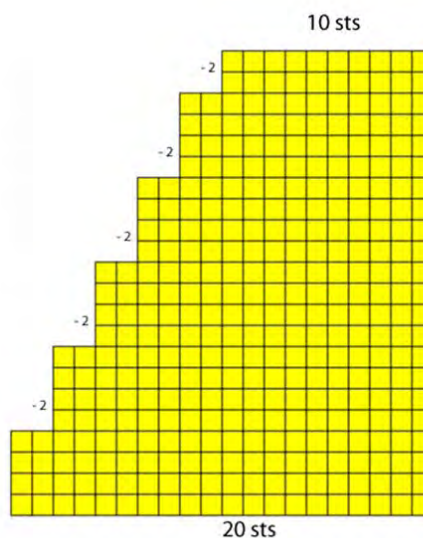
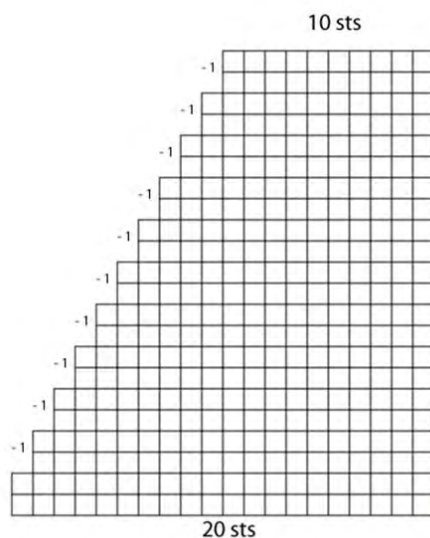
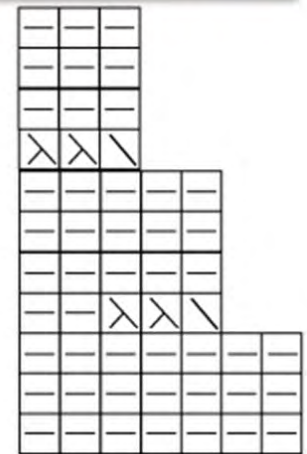
Simple Every 4th Row Decrease



Even though your pattern may instruct you to decrease 1 stitch every other row ... consider changing the rate of your decreases.

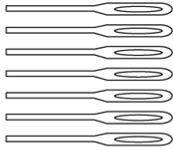
In the following example, you start and end with the same number of stitches, decreasing 10 stitches. But you decrease 2 stitches every 4th row, creating a decorative seam.

- Use a multi-prong transfer tool, decrease 2 stitches, (2 stitches on 2 needles) every 4th row
- For easier seaming, keep 1 single stitch on the edge for seaming.



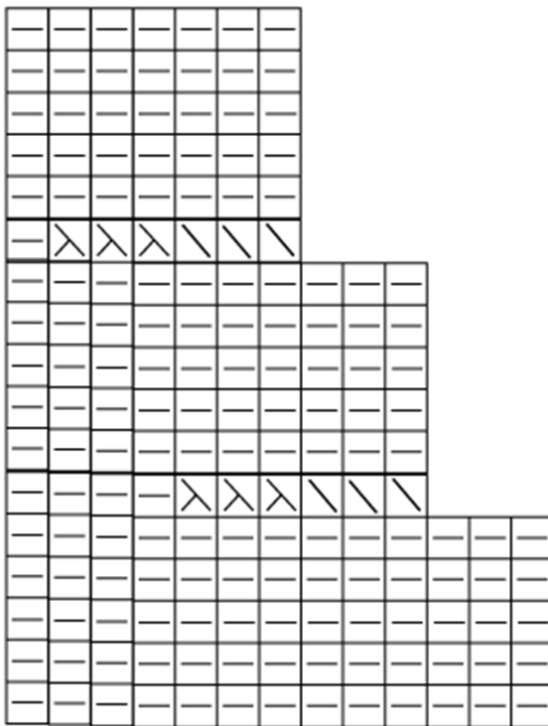
Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

Simple Every 6th Row Decrease



Decrease 3 stitches every 6th row.

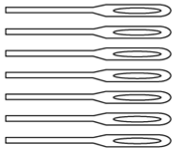
- Use a multi-prong transfer tool, decrease 3 stitches, (2 stitches on 3 needles) every 6th row
- For easier seaming, keep 1 single stitch on the edge for seaming.



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

Fancy Decreases

Bias Decrease

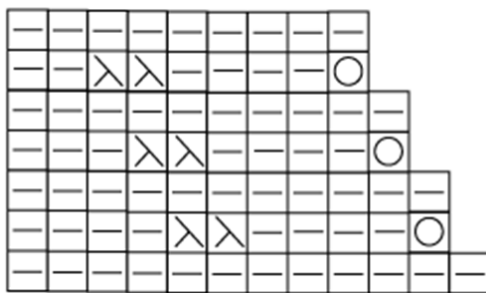
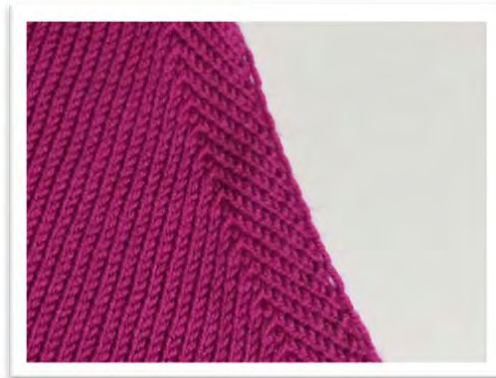


Change the direction of the seam with a bias decrease. By decreasing and increasing on the same row, the stitches are skewed at an angle creating an attractive bias.

NOTE: Even though you are transferring multiple stitches, you will be decreasing the number of stitches in work by only 1 on each decrease row.

First Edge:

- Use a multi-prong transfer tool
- Work a multi-stitch decrease, placing 2 stitches on 2 needles, emptying 2 needles at the edge of the work.
- Keep the emptied needle closest to the work in working position. Place the outside emptied needle in out of work position (completing the decrease)
- Knit 2 rows
- Keeping the emptied needle in work will form a loop on the edge of the work.



Pick up the increase loops for sew-as-you-go

Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

Second Edge:

- Reversing the shaping, work a 2 stitch decrease over same number of needles as the other piece
- There will be 2 emptied needles on the edge.
- Put the outside emptied needle into out of work position
- Hang a loop from the first piece on the remaining emptied needle.
- Keeping this needle in working position, Knit 2 rows



the

Both the small eyelets that are formed and the bias effect make this an attractive seam.



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

1 over 2 Twist

Adding cables along the inside of a raglan seam can add interest to your sweaters.



- Using a 2 prong tool, remove stitches 6-5 and hold
- Transfer stitch 4 to needle 6
- Rehang stitch 6-5 on the empty needles (cable)
- Using a 2 prong tool work a simple decrease on the edge. 2 stitches on needle 3. Edge stitch on needle 2 and the emptied, decrease needle 1 in out of work position
- Knit 2 rows and repeat as needed.



Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters



1 Over 2 Twist Challenge

Make it your own!

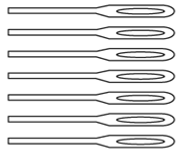
- Combine techniques
- Vary the twisted stitches
- Change the position of the cable



Hint: Alternate the 1 stitch transfer left and right

Decorative Raglan Seams for Machine Knitters

Arrowheads



Decrease 1 stitch every other row as instructed, transferring one less stitch each time.

- Mark the decrease needle on your needlebed (8th needle, grey box on diagram)
- Work a simple decrease by transferring the edge stitches over one space. 2 stitches on the marked needle
- Knit 2 rows to complete the decrease
- Repeat the transfer, placing 2 stitches on the marked needle each time, transferring 1 less stitch each time



Row 1: Transfer 7 stitches to the left 1 needle, placing 2 stitches on the marked needle. Knit across.

Row 2: Knit

Row 3: Transfer 6 stitches to the left 1 needle, placing 2 stitches on the marked needle. Knit across.

Row 4: Knit

Row 5: Transfer 5 stitches to the left 1 needle, placing 2 stitches on the marked needle. Knit across.

Row 6: Knit

Row 7: Transfer 4 stitches to the left 1 needle, placing 2 stitches on the marked needle. Knit across.

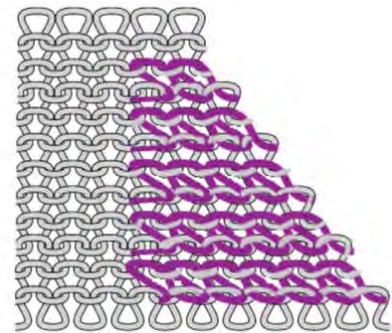
Row 8: Knit

Row 9: Transfer 3 stitches to the left 1 needle, placing 2 stitches on the marked needle. Knit across.

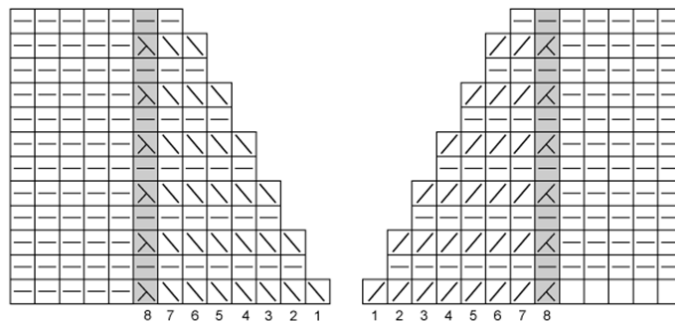
Row 10: Knit

Row 11: Transfer 2 stitches to the left 1 needle, placing 2 stitches on the marked needle. Knit across.

Row 12: Knit



Repeat these 12 rows for pattern



Decorative Raglan Seams

for Machine Knitters



Want more?

*Look for the video tutorials
about decorative raglan decreases*

*in the
Knit it Now Learning Library*

*Subscribers have unlimited access to
hundreds of tutorials, plus patterns, discounts
and more!*



Two stitches on the needle



Transfer right



Transfer left



Eyelet

Machine knitters need to keep in mind that we are looking at our work from the purl side
Examine the stitches used and imagine how they will look on the public side of the work.

Don't let the words "left" and "right" get you confused. Create a mental picture of the finished item before you start to knit.